



MOZAMBIQUE CASE STUDY REPORT

Evaluation of UNICEF Work in Strengthening Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems



MOZAMBIQUE CASE STUDY REPORT

Evaluation of UNICEF Work in Strengthening Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems

Mozambique Case Study Report. Evaluation of the UNICEF Work in Strengthening Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems

© United Nations Children's Fund, New York, 2021
United Nations Children's Fund
Three United Nations Plaza
New York, New York 10017

The purpose of publishing evaluation reports produced by the UNICEF Evaluation Office is to fulfil a corporate commitment to transparency through the publication of all completed evaluations. The reports are designed to stimulate a free exchange of ideas among those interested in the topic and to assure those supporting the work of UNICEF that it rigorously examines its strategies, results and overall effectiveness.

This report, 'Mozambique Case Study Report. Evaluation of the UNICEF Work in Strengthening Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems' was prepared by Zoran Dokovic. Eduard Bonet Porqueras, Evaluation Specialist at the Evaluation Office, managed the overall evaluation with support from Beth Ann Plowman, Senior Evaluation Specialist at the Evaluation Office. Edward Isaac Freeman provided technical advice and guidance as external expert.

The contents of the report do not necessarily reflect the policies or views of UNICEF. The views expressed in this report are those of the evaluators. The text has not been edited to official publication standards and UNICEF accepts no responsibility for error. The designations in this publication do not imply an opinion on the legal status of any country or territory, or of its authorities, or the delimitation of frontiers.

The copyright for this report is held by the United Nations Children's Fund. Permission is required to reprint/reproduce/photocopy or in any other way cite or quote from this report in written form. UNICEF has a formal permission policy that requires a written request to be submitted. For non-commercial uses, the permission will normally be granted free of charge. Please write to the Evaluation Office at the address below to initiate a permission request.

For further information, please contact:

Evaluation Office United Nations Children's Fund
Three United Nations Plaza
New York, New York 10017
evalhelp@unicef.org

Cover photo:
©UNICEF/UN0567032/Franco

TABLE OF CONTENTS

List of Acronyms	iv
Executive Summary	1
1 Introduction	3
1.1 Background	3
1.2 Methodology	3
2 Country context on civil registration and vital statistics	4
2.1 Country context	4
2.2 Intervention logic to strengthen the CRVS system	7
2.3 Mapping of strategies used	9
2.4 Mapping of planned and attained products	11
3 UNICEF's work in civil registration and vital statistics	13
3.1 Programming	13
3.2 Measurable contributions	13
3.3 Outputs and strategies	14
4 Key observations	18
4.1 Relevance	18
4.2 Effectiveness	18
4.3 Coherence	19
4.4 Innovation	20
5 Conclusions and considerations	21
5.1 Limitations of this case study	21
5.2 Lessons learned and good practices	21
5.3 Issues for future investigation	22
Annexes	24
Annex 1 Data for evidence story	24
Annex 2 List of documents reviewed	25



LIST OF ACRONYMS

APAI-CRVS	Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics
ASSD	African Symposiums on Statistical Development
COVID-19	Coronavirus disease
CRVS	Civil Registration and Vital Statistics
DHS	Demographic and Health Survey
e-CRVS	Electronic Civil Registration and Vital Statistics
GITEV	Inter-ministerial Group for Civil Registration and Vital Statistics
ICT	Information and communications technology
ID	Identity document
ID4D	Identification for Development
INE	National Institute of Statistics
MoI	Ministry of Interior
MoJCAR	Ministry of Justice, Constitutional Affairs and Religions
NDRN	National Directorate of Registries and Notaries
NUIC	Unique Civil Identification Number
SADC	Southern African Development Community
SMS	Short Message Service
SP	Strategic Plan
UNCT	United Nations Country Team
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNECA	United Nations Economic Commission for Africa
UNFPA	United Nations Population Fund
UNHCR	United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
USSD	Unstructured Supplementary Service Data
WHO	World Health Organization



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The civil registration and vital statistics (CRVS) system in Mozambique at one time looked much like those of many African countries, characterized by low birth registration rates and an inability to generate vital statistics from vital events records. The two most recent demographic and health surveys (DHS) indicate that in 2012 only 48 per cent of children under 5 years old had their births registered, while in 2015 it was 55 per cent. While no additional survey data are available since then, official statistics show that, year on year, four times as many births were registered in 2018 and 2019, and also four times as many births were registered in the first quarter of 2020 (pre-pandemic) compared to the same quarter in the previous year.

Backed by strong Government commitment, along with support from UNICEF and other international organizations, the CRVS system in Mozambique has since 2012 undergone major reforms transforming birth and death registration business processes, with innovations in the way data are registered and processed. Newly introduced registration processes facilitate registration in terms of reporting occurrence

of vital life events and obtaining registration certificates. The foundations of the newly overhauled CRVS system are the decentralization of registration responsibilities and the shifting of paper-based registration systems into a largely digitized registration data processing system.

UNICEF support to Mozambique's CRVS system reforms demonstrates that UNICEF can be a key



partner of the national authorities in strengthening of the national CRVS system. While sustaining national ownership of the process, UNICEF support was essential for the development and implementation of the national strategic plan for CRVS. UNICEF also demonstrated how other international development stakeholders could be mobilized for the implementation of the national strategic plan. UNICEF advocated for and provided technical support to revise the legislative framework and supported the Government in expanding the network of registration points and training an enlarged workforce of registration agents. This extends to the revision of birth and death registration forms to align them with the newly established electronic civil registration and vital statistics (e-CRVS) processing system and enable the use of mobile birth notification. Both services were developed with the support of UNICEF and were fully operational as of 2018. The birth and death registration e-CRVS system has been rolled out in 80 per cent of district civil registration offices, prioritizing remote areas.

UNICEF assistance was provided within the existing coordination mechanism for CRVS, the inter-ministerial working group on vital statistics (GITEV). This allowed UNICEF to contribute to national ownership and facilitate timely resolution of challenges throughout the reform process. However, a stronger political agreement within the national coordination mechanism would have facilitated achieving tighter integration of the action of all the stakeholders within the CRVS system, as well as a broader expansion of registration in all health facilities across the country.



1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

Baseline disaggregated data from the two most recent demographic and health survey (DHS) reports (2011 and 2015) reveal that birth registration services were more accessible in urban areas than rural ones, and to children from wealthier families. While registration rates increased over time, in 2015 there remained a gap between urban and rural and wealthier versus poor populations. Major reforms that began in 2016 focused on making birth registration services more accessible to the rural population. Official statistics published until 2021 show a steady increase in the number of registered births across the country regions and facilities, during the last three years. Additional data collected in 2021 through the latest DHS will provide important insights on the achievements since 2016. Significantly, monitoring data suggest that birth registration is still not covering some 30 per cent of children, especially the most marginalized, thereby limiting their ability to access basic social and health care services.

1.2 Methodology

This report was produced using information obtained from an in-depth desk review and it was complemented with the information obtained from key informant interviews. The selection of Mozambique as a case study for the evaluation was done according to several criteria explained in the evaluation report. The evaluation methodology used for this country case study is based on theory-based contribution analysis and is used to elaborate on the relative

influence/contribution of the UNICEF Country Office to a known, discernible change or result. For this evaluation, those known, discernible changes are based primarily on the access, inclusion and coverage of birth registration as officially established over an observed period of time, from 2014 to 2020 (pre-COVID-19). While the analysis is based on these years, elements from before 2014 have been included whenever it has been appropriate to bring a historic context and perspective to the main developments during the observed time period. Progress in rates of registration of other vital events is also considered.

The analysis aims to provide detailed information on the actions of UNICEF, the government and other partners in order to adequately tell the 'contribution story'. To that end the analysis is centred on elaborating the CRVS-strengthening logic of intervention of the national stakeholders as well as that of UNICEF in Mozambique. The methodology focuses further on the analysis, which aims to verify the steps and assumptions in the logic of intervention, their realization in practice, and other major factors contributing to the results. This way, the analysis provides a granular view of what works specifically related to the strengthening of the CRVS systems. Based on observed results, this report focuses on why and how the result was achieved, whether UNICEF-supported efforts influenced or made an important contribution to the observed result, and what role that intervention played vis-à-vis those of other actors.



2 COUNTRY CONTEXT ON CIVIL REGISTRATION AND VITAL STATISTICS

2.1 Country context

.....
Mozambique shares its borders with Tanzania, Malawi, Zambia, Zimbabwe, Eswatini and South Africa and is a member of the Southern African Development Community (SADC).
.....

Capital city: Maputo

Official working language: Portuguese

Territorial size: 799,380 km²

Total population: 28,861,863

Ministry responsible for civil registration:

Ministry of Justice, Constitutional Affairs and Religions (MoJCAR)

Civil registration agency: National Directorate of Registries and Notaries (NDRN)

<https://civil.registos.gov.mz/crvs/>

National statistical office: National Institute of Statistics (INE) <http://www.ine.gov.mz>




Figure 1: Key vital statistics indicators

Births	
Completeness of birth registration	Not available
Children under 5 years of age whose births were reported as registered	55% (2015) ¹
Births attended by skilled health personnel	54% (2011) ²
Crude birth rate (per 1,000 population)	37.8 (2017) ³
Total fertility rate (live births per woman)	4.9 (2018) ⁴
Adolescent fertility rate (per 1,000 girls aged 15-19 years)	146 (2018) ⁵
Deaths	
Completeness of death registration	Not available
Crude death rate (per 1,000 population)	9 (2018) ⁶
Infant mortality rate (per 1,000 live births)	55 (2019) ⁷
Under five mortality rate (per 1,000 live births)	74 (2019) ⁸
Maternal mortality ratio (per 100,000 live births)	289 (2017) ⁹

Prior to 2016, the CRVS system in Mozambique was characterized by a lack of institutional capacities and services supply. There was insufficient demand from the population for birth registration, stemming from a perceived

lack of value. The most recent estimate of the death registration rate, done by NDRN/National Institute of Statistics in 2014, indicates that only 13 per cent of deaths in the country were being registered. Completeness of marriage

¹ Ministério da Saúde- MISAU, Instituto Nacional de Estatística - INE, and ICF. 2018. Inquérito de Indicadores de Imunização, Malária e HIV/SIDA em Moçambique - IMASIDA, 2015. Maputo/Moçambique: MISAU/Moçambique, INE, and ICF.

² Ministry of Health. Ministerio da Saude (MISAU), Instituto Nacional de Estatística (INE) e ICF International (ICFI). Moçambique Inquérito Demográfico e de Saúde 2011. Calverton, Maryland, USA: MISAU, INE e ICFI.

³ World Bank, 'Birth Rate, crude (per 1,000 people), Mozambique', 2017, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.DYN.CBRT.IN?locations=MZ>, accessed 25 February 2021.

⁴ World Bank, 'Fertility Rate, total (births per woman), Mozambique', 2018, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.DYN.TFRT.IN?locations=MZ>, accessed 25 February 2021.

⁵ World Bank, 'Adolescent Fertility Rate (births per 1,000 women ages 15-19), Mozambique', 2018, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.ADO.TFRT?locations=MZ>, accessed 25 February 2021.

⁶ World Bank, 'Death Rate, crude (per 1,000 people), Mozambique', 2018, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.DYN.CDRT.IN?locations=MZ>, accessed 25 February 2021.

⁷ United Nations Children's Fund, 'UNICEF Data Warehouse, Cross-sector indicators', UNICEF, New York, 2019, https://data.unicef.org/resources/data_explorer/unicef_f?ag=UNICEF&df=GLOBAL_DATAFLOW&ver=1.0&dq=MOZ.CME_MRY0.&startPeriod=1970&endPeriod=2020, accessed 25 February 2021.

⁸ Ibid.

⁹ World Bank, 'Maternal Mortality Ratio (modeled estimate, per 100,000 live births), Mozambique', 2017, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SH.STA.MMRT?locations=MZ>, accessed 25 February 2021.

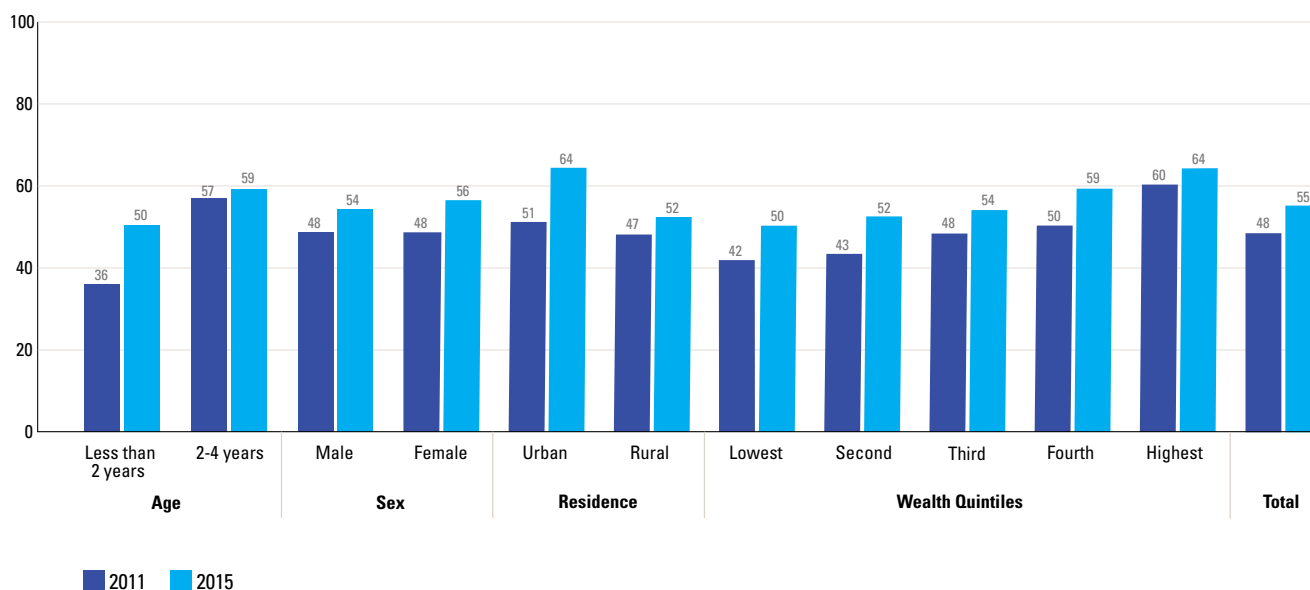


and divorce registration has to date not been a subject of assessment and the percentage remains undetermined.

Registration of birth has been prioritized systematically over the last decade in order to address low registration rates and large disparities in terms registration rates across different population groups. Two recent DHS surveys, from 2011 and 2015, provide evidence of gradually increasing but still low birth registration rates for children under 5 years old (Figure 2). In 2015, overall birth registration completeness was estimated at 55 per cent. The surveys show that timeliness of the registrations was an issue of particular concern, with only

36 per cent of births registered within two years. The statistics further revealed that more girls were registered than boys, albeit slightly. Another gap was evident between registration rates among urban and rural populations, with the former registering at higher rates. This gap widened between the two surveys, from 3.8 per cent in 2011 to 11.8 per cent in 2015. Wealth also determines access to birth registration services, with the wealthiest population more likely to have birth events registered. The gap between the lowest and highest wealth quintile narrowed between the two surveys, from 17.9 per cent in 2011 to 13.8 per cent in 2015 (see Annex 1).

Figure 2: Percentage of children under five years old who have their birth registered in Mozambique, 2011–2015

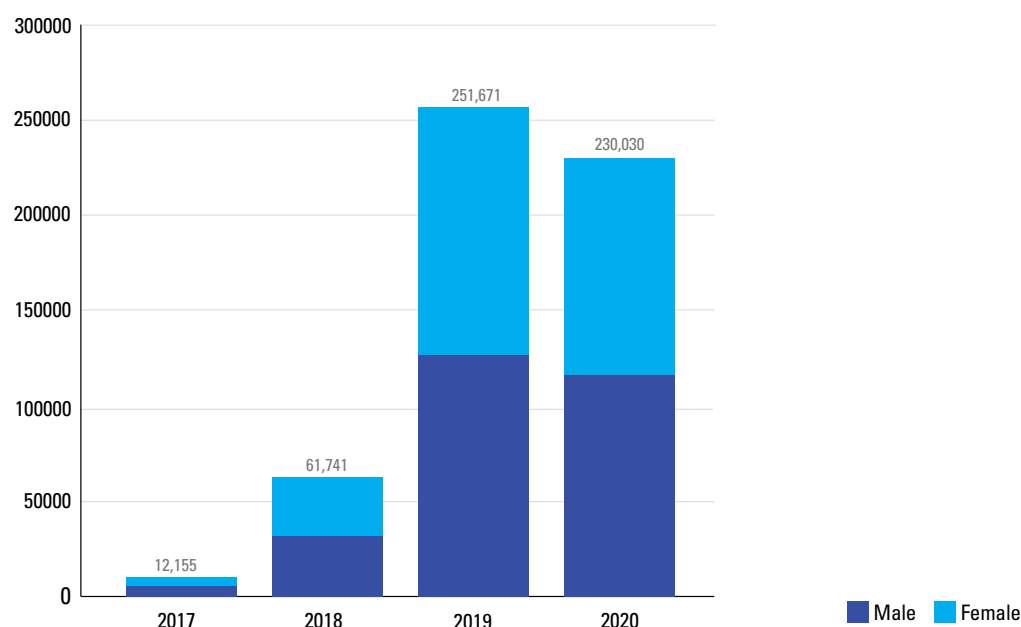




A similar survey compatible with DHS methodology has not been conducted since 2015. Therefore, comparable data that could reflect changes in birth registration rates during the period of major CRVS reforms (starting from 2016) are not available. However, the statistical data published by NDRN as a product of the digitized CRVS system does provide a real-time overview of the number of registered births and deaths starting from 2017. The statistical overview of registered births from 2017–2020 presented in

Figure 3 shows a dramatic increase in the number of births registered from 2017–2019. When compared to 2017, the number of registered births in 2018 increased by a factor of five. The number of births registered in 2019 then quadrupled when compared to 2018. In 2020, a drop in number of births registered was recorded mainly due to the coronavirus disease 2019 (COVID-19) outbreak. By 2020, girls and boys benefitted equally from access to birth registration, in contrast to the small gap evident in DHS surveys from 2011 and 2015.

Figure 3: Number of registered births in Mozambique, 2017–2020¹⁰



2.2 Intervention logic behind efforts to strengthen the CRVS system

The Government of Mozambique's commitment to addressing the underdeveloped national CRVS system reflects wider regional developments. The importance of strengthening national

CRVS systems has been underlined in various documents and resolutions passed by the conferences of African ministers responsible for civil registration held in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia in 2010, in Durban, South Africa in 2012 and in Yamoussoukro, Cote d'Ivoire in 2015. The design of Mozambique's CRVS reforms was informed

¹⁰ National Directorate of Registries and Notaries, Sistema de registo civil e estatísticas vitais, Government of Mozambique, <https://civil.registos.gov.mz/crvs/Report/Birth>, accessed 10 February 2021.

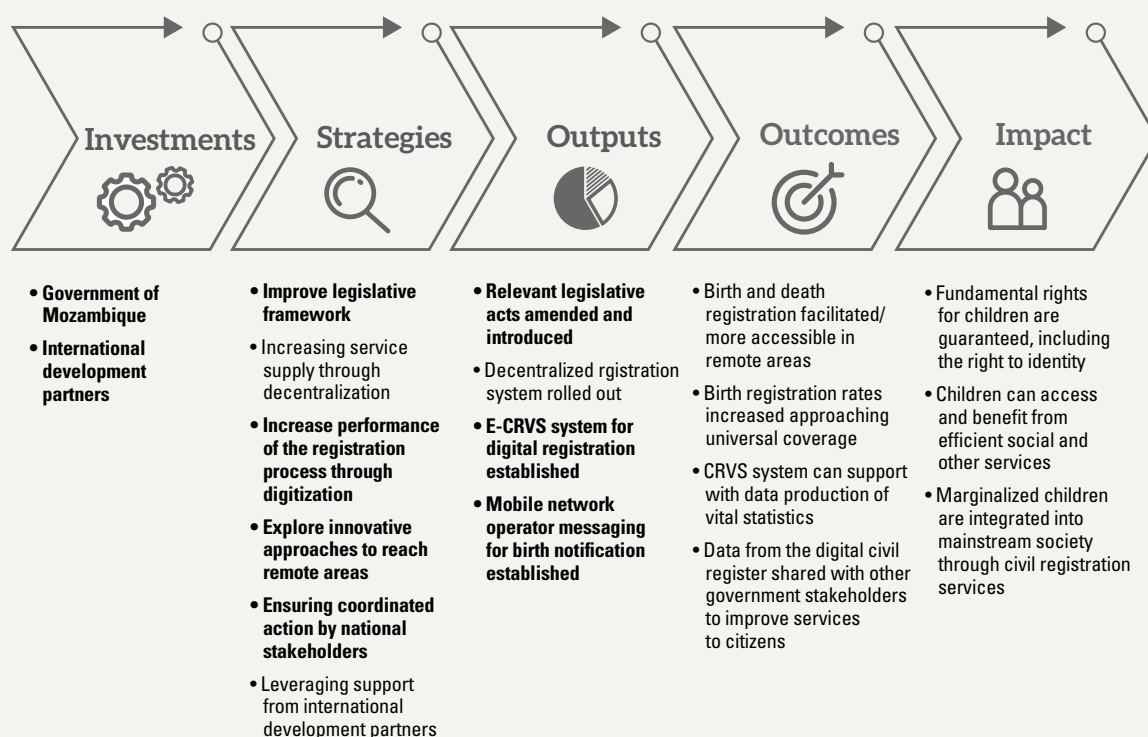


by a comprehensive assessment conducted with UNICEF support as per the methodology developed by the Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics (APAI-CRVS).

The intervention logic of these reforms resulted from consultations within the national coordination mechanism elaborated in the National Strategic Plan for CRVS, 2015–2019.

Although the strategy is not formally structured to outline a theory of change, an intervention logic can be constructed based on the content of the document, as presented in Figure 4. The elements of intervention logic highlighted in blue underline investments, strategies and outputs where UNICEF provided a significant contribution. This contribution further extends to all outcomes and impact of these interventions.

Figure 4: Elements of intervention logic behind CRVS strengthening in Mozambique



Source: National Strategic Plan for CRVS, 2015–2019

* The intervention logic for UNICEF CO mirrors that of the government in many ways. As such, UNICEF's areas of intervention are highlighted in **bold** above and reflect the investments, strategies, outputs, outcomes, and impacts pursued through UNICEF's interventions.



2.3 Mapping of strategies used

Maintaining political commitment through national CRVS coordination mechanism

In 2012, a memorandum of understanding signed by the Ministries of Justice and Health, the National Institute of Statistics and by the University Eduardo Mondlane, created the inter-ministerial working group on vital statistics (GITEV), a coordination mechanism tasked with coordinating the improvement of the national CRVS system. The composition of the GITEV was adjusted in 2017 and now comprises six ministries, including the Ministries of Home Affairs, State Administration, Science and Technology, and Foreign Affairs. Development partners such as UNICEF, Jembi-Moasis, the World Health Organization (WHO) and others are also invited to join the activities of GITEV. The creation of the inter-ministerial group has resulted in better coordination of activities and successful joint mobilization of resources. UNICEF supported the forming of GITEV and contributed to it as one of the members appointed from among international development partner organizations.

Increasing service supply through decentralization

The decentralization of registration services was recognized as key strategy in driving the registration rates higher. It offered a wide range of opportunities for facilitation, and a better enabling environment for increasing the coverage rates of vital events. The decentralization and expanding the number of registration agents ultimately resulted in increased supply of registration services. It eliminated the obstacles linked to the large distances an applicant needed to travel in order to reach a registration office (often multiple times) in order to register an event. As a result of the decentralization, the workload is delegated over a broader range of authorities: from the central registration authority to the local authorities, as well as to local health facilities. This approach lifts the burden from the central registration authority

of operating a large number of offices across the country. Specific aspects of the registration process, such as notification of births and deaths, are delegated to the local authorities and/or health facilities, whereas the civil registration authority maintains its role of supervising and setting registration policies for the authorities responsible for delegated aspects of the process. Central to the success of this strategy was the commitment of local authorities to take over specific aspects of the registration process.

Increase performance of the registration process through digitization

Mozambique is among the first African countries to identify and operationalize information and communication technologies (ICT) as a cross-cutting issue and a key development tool for CRVS. From the onset of the inter-ministerial discussions, the development of a national digitized civil register emerged as a key strategic direction. The use of digital technologies provides for easier aggregation of registered data as well as their processing, storing and sharing. In the digitized system, registration records can be retrieved instantly, including remotely from computers connected via secured computer networks or over the internet using wired or wireless/mobile networks. The existing governmental computer network was utilized for the digital capturing of registration data at registration points in the field. District registration offices also benefit from using the network to access registration records kept in the central register. The building of a digitized system was prioritized to allow for future sharing of registration data with the ICT platforms of other public administration actors. For instance, birth and other civil registration records can be accessed directly when issuing identification documents or travel documents. The information can be also extended to the authorities responsible for other functional registers, such as health or social protection. For the general population, registered events can be certified in any registration centre across the country, or in the future, verified directly in the database when requesting access to services.



Innovation

In Mozambique, an innovative approach was required to overcome the lack of ICT infrastructure outside of urban centres. Although implemented by national authorities in cooperation with other national partners, this innovative approach and its resulting products were initially developed by UNICEF and handed over for later use by the registration authorities. Mobile operator network-based services were leveraged to allow for the digital transfer of registered data. The use of unstructured supplementary service data (USSD) messaging was introduced as a means of communicating registered information in areas lacking ICT infrastructure. It enables authorized users with a mobile phone to notify of an event (birth or death) using text messaging, which is immediately available (in real-time) in the central database. This expands the reach of the system in remote locations. An offline system has also been devised, which enables for registrations to be carried out when there is no connectivity, enabling data to synchronize when a connection becomes available. SMS notifications are being used as a means of notifying users that their certificates are ready, a mechanism that enables citizens to plan their visit to a conservatory to collect a birth or death certificate.

The web platform brings real-time access to data to members of the public, other stakeholders and partners, enabling system users to manage the events, obtain statistical data and monitor activity across all registrations posts across the country. A call centre was also established to provide support to system users, as well as to respond to enquiries from the public.

Pursuing partnership with the development partners

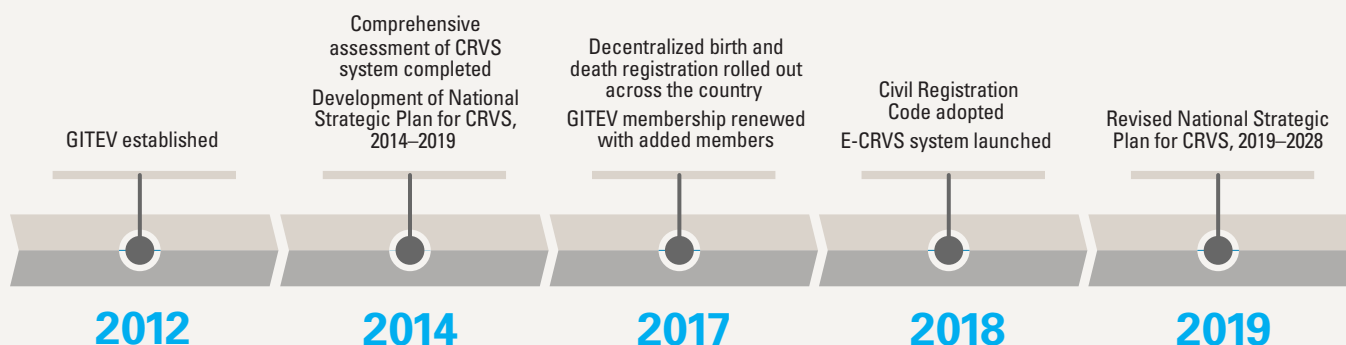
Reform of the CRVS system in Mozambique would not have been successful were it not for the sustained support of development partners. From the United Nations system side, UNICEF was recognized as a main partner in delivering on key

products. Funding from the Government of Canada was also an important enabler of the reform. Canadian support was utilized through a UNICEF-run project modelled on the intervention logic of the national strategic plan.

The CRVS system is expected to be further strengthened by improving the interoperability between CRVS and the health information system. The World Bank Mozambique Primary Health Care Strengthening Programme, begun in 2017, aims among other goals to improve birth and death data in the health information system and strengthen data-sharing with the CRVS system. The World Bank is also recognized as a partner in strengthening the national identification system through its Identification for Development (ID4D) programme. In that context, new opportunities are being explored to further strengthen the link between CRVS systems and the system for issuance of national identity cards.

The WHO supported strengthening the capacity of a multidisciplinary core team of 25 people at central level consisting of paediatricians, obstetricians and monitoring and evaluation officers to support maternal and neonatal deaths surveillance and response committees in the use of the information system. The team conducted supportive visits in seven of Mozambique's 11 provinces to ensure proper use of the maternal and neonatal deaths notification system, including the use of the ICD-10 classification. The committee reviewed maternal and neonatal deaths to determine and classify cause of death at all levels and the first national report was produced and approved by the Ministry of Health.

With the support of Italian Cooperation, an Italian development agency, the Ministry of Justice, Constitutional Affairs and Religions (MoJCAR) is planning to begin digitizing the vital events paper records archive. This assistance will allow the digitization of a large proportion of historic records and as result increase the efficiency of registration business processes, including the issuance of vital events registration certificates.


Figure 5: Key milestones


2.4 Mapping of planned and attained outputs

Building on strong political commitment for CRVS reforms, the availability of external donor funding, support from international development partners and the commitment of key national stakeholders, significant progress has been achieved in delivering CRVS products as envisaged in the national strategic plan.

Legislative changes

The Government of Mozambique revised existing civil registration law by enacting Civil Registration Code 12/2018, issued on 4 December 2018 and brought into force the same year. The new code provides the legislative framework for registering births, marriages, divorces, deaths and adoptions. The law is aligned with international recommendations and practices, as it makes registration of vital events mandatory. It is also universal, as it covers the entire territory of the country and all population groups, including refugees and stateless persons. The revised legal framework requires community leaders and health personnel to notify the occurrence of births and deaths. It also provides a conducive environment for the introduction and use of technologies such as SMS for notifications and the generation of a single citizen's identification number. Adoption of the Law

on Unique Identification Number (NUIC) provided the legal basis for the assignment of a number/code that is unique to each individual in the country.

Decentralization

The decentralized registration system became operational in 2017 and expanded the number of civil registration agents appointed at the level of village and local communities. Prior to the reforms, vital events could only be registered at designated registration centres. Registration books were kept in provincial offices, and anyone who needed a registration certificate could only obtain one at the provincial office where the original registration record was kept. For a large proportion of the population, therefore, registration was a cumbersome and costly process.

In line with its decentralized approach, Mozambique has created an elaborate network of 534 registration points, where birth and death data are captured in registration forms not long after the events have occurred. Without requiring any further intervention from the informants, these forms are processed by the designated district registration offices where registration records are completed. At the end of this process, the informant is notified via SMS that the registration certificate is ready for collection at the nearest district office. Key information from the completed registration forms in local communities can be



also transmitted over mobile operator networks to the central registration authority (NDRN), where it is stored in a central electronic database. District registration offices can also remotely connect to the central e-CRVS electronic platform and enter registration data directly into the central electronic civil database. Services thus became more accessible to the population, with registration points closer to the place where they live. Even so, two separate journeys are still required, first to register and then to collect the certificate, which can only be done at the district offices. In remote parts of the country, this may require lengthy travel.

Digitization

Since 2016, the Government of Mozambique has instituted massive reforms in the way registration data are processed and stored by establishing a digitized CRVS system. All district registration offices, as well as a number of administrative posts in the country, use computers to register vital events. As of October 2018, births and deaths are registered and certificates processed electronically using the e-CRVS system, which currently reaches 80 per cent of civil registration administrative units and districts. The system also generates the unique identification numbers that provide every citizen with a number that will be utilized for provision of all services throughout their lives.

The registration process was redesigned to ensure that the information captured at the administrative points is communicated to the central database as quickly as possible. All district registration offices are equipped with internet-connected computers, and registrations done at the district are immediately digitized. Mobile birth notification was introduced as a means of digitally capturing registration information at administrative points where computers and internet connectivity are not available. Mobile birth notification is compiled by the registration agent and transmitted from a mobile phone number preauthorized by

NDRN over the available mobile network to the NDRN head office, where it is entered into the notifications database. The introduction of birth notification with mobile messaging technology has increased the number of geographic locations where birth registration can be initiated, including the notification of the birth of a child without a name, or with incomplete information. This allows the parents to complete the information at a later stage (within the 120-day period) without paying an extra fee.

Implementation of the unique civil identification number (NUIC) is critical for the digitization of the civil registration system and is also a key enabler of interoperability of personal data among all government actors that interact with citizens and require their personal data. The NUIC is communicated to the parents right after the birth of a child has been notified. Once the NUIC is issued, any subsequent request to update personal information, register another vital life event or to look up personal data on government or commercial ICT platforms can be facilitated by presenting a NUIC. The number follows the person from birth until death and enables an additional level of verification with every subsequent update in the civil register.

Generating demand for registration

Improvements on the supply side of the CRVS system were supported by efforts to increase the demand for registration. Each year, Mozambique conducts two rounds of “National Health Weeks”, an integrated campaign providing preventative health and nutrition services to every community in Mozambique. The two health weeks in 2014 helped register 193,081 children under 5 years of age. In Cabo Delgado, Manica and Zambezia, more than 200,00 children were registered by mobile brigades. Following UNICEF advocacy efforts, the Government committed to maintaining birth registration as a part of National Health Weeks.



3 UNICEF'S WORK IN CIVIL REGISTRATION AND VITAL STATISTICS

3.1 Programming

Within UNICEF, support to strengthening of the CRVS system falls under the purview of the child protection programme. One of the programme's four strategic outputs is "a decentralized and digitized CRVS system rolled out and fully operational nationwide by 2020". This output is aligned with Outcome 8 of the United Nations Sustainable Development and Cooperation Framework for Mozambique: "All people benefit from democratic and transparent governance institutions and systems that guarantee peace consolidation, human rights and equitable service delivery. It is also linked to meeting several Sustainable Development Goals, such as 16 & 17 (Peace and Justice Strong Institutions, Partnerships for the Goals).

3.2 Measurable contributions

Human resources

Support to CRVS strengthening is provided by one child protection systems officer (P4), a junior professional officer and one national professional officer (NO3), who are directly tasked with strengthening of the CRVS system.

Financial resources

The overall budget of the child protection section during the observed period averaged between \$8.2-9.2 million annually, approximately one quarter of which was allocated to the CRVS component. A notable part of funding originates from Global Affairs Canada, through a grant aiming to accelerate birth and death notification and registration rates through the rollout of a national digitized civil registration system (in collaboration with the Ministries of Justice, Health and Interior, the National Bureau of Statistics, Save the Children and WHO).

In 2014, UNICEF invested \$2.4 million in CRVS, including in birth registration. The Government of Mozambique also increased the fiscal space related to CRVS activities, paying close attention to e-CRVS rollout, investing a total of \$135,000 in 2014. In partnership with other United Nations agencies, UNICEF Mozambique supported the Government with the development of a preliminary costed investment plan, which has also led to the development of a five-year costed operational plan for CRVS. In 2019, UNICEF and Global Affairs Canada agreed for an additional two years funding for CRVS programming, allowing the continuation of the joint programme.

Figure 6: UNICEF Mozambique funding overview, 2014–2020 (in USD)

UNICEF Mozambique							
2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	TOTAL
1,573,848	506,620	2,184,930	6,273,458	4,277,843	2,081,557	434,448	17,332,704

Source: UNICEF, Vision funds utilization reports, own elaboration



3.3 Outputs and strategies

1 Provide every child with a certificate upon birth

UNICEF Mozambique has been involved from the very beginning in facilitating a national political commitment to improving the CRVS system in Mozambique. UNICEF Mozambique works closely with the United Nations Economic Commission for Africa (UNECA) in the context of the APAI-CRVS Regional Core Group, which led to Mozambique being the first African country to conduct a comprehensive CRVS assessment and develop an investment plan and a costed operational plan. The latter formed the basis for the implementation of reforms, the main component of which took place in the period 2014–2019, with the goal of accelerating birth and death notification and registration rates through decentralization of registration responsibilities and the rollout of a national digitized civil registration system as described above.

In 2014, UNICEF Mozambique was already active in advocating for the legal reforms necessary to implement the recommendations of the comprehensive assessment, in particular those allowing for the digitization and decentralization of registration responsibilities. This advocacy contributed to the adoption of the civil registration code described above. UNICEF also actively contributed to the Government-led process of drafting a new strategic plan for CRVS to secure investment for a sustainable system. Ever since, UNICEF Mozambique has focused on advocating for expanding partnership agreements with the Ministry of Justice, Constitutional and Religious Affairs (MoJCAR) and the Ministry of Health. Expansion of registration points as part of the decentralized registration system and the training of health workers for notification of births is recognized as central to further increasing birth registration coverage.

2 Invest in safe and innovative technological solutions to facilitate birth registration

As early as 2014, UNICEF began supporting digitization by contracting two data management specialists from Uganda to support the Government in developing a new database and e-CRVS. With the funding support from the Government of Canada, UNICEF proceeded in 2015 to support the development of a full information management system for civil registration, which also integrates components for communicating notification of vital events and electronic sharing of registration data using web-based interfaces and mobile network-based services. The system was primarily designed to focus on the registration of births and deaths, while leaving scope for adding the registration of marriage and divorce at later stage. From the planning phase to the actual implementation of the system, UNICEF Mozambique was the main driver of implementation, in close collaboration with the MoJCAR.

The electronic civil registration system design was completed and tested in 2016, and quality assured by Government with validation by the MoJCAR and the Ministry of Justice, Science and Technology and the National Institute of Technology. UNICEF supported partnerships with mobile registration operators to enable transfer of registration data over mobile networks, resulting in memoranda of understanding being signed with the three main telecom service providers in the country. For the rollout of e-CRVS, UNICEF procured equipment for 28 selected test sites, including a server room. The server functions alongside the call service centre for technical support. Internet connectivity was assured for all sites. Linkages with health centres and the National Bureau of Statistics for analysis of vital events were consolidated. The operational capacity of registration posts was increased in three districts of Nampula (Murrupula, Moma



and Mogovolas), two in Manica (Chimoio and Manica), one in Gaza (Xai- Xai), one in Cabo Delgado (Pemba) and one in Zambezia (Pebane). The e-CRVS system was set up in Maputo, and capacity-building and institutional support at the National Directorate of Registry and Notary continued. Forty civil registration staff were trained based on the newly developed manuals on e-CRVS. The advocacy efforts of UNICEF Mozambique resulted in joint planning between the Ministries of Health and Justice and the selection of 38 additional health facilities to open birth registration sites.

The building of the e-CRVS system in Mozambique took several years and involved multiple stakeholders. System implementation was carefully supported and managed by UNICEF under Government leadership. The e-CRVS software platform was developed by national ICT experts under the general guidance of the National Institute of Information Technology, with UNICEF support. It consists of a front-end web application designed to run within a web browser installed on any computer connected to the internet. Back-end components are executed on the server at NDRN headquarters, and they are designed to:

- Manage MySQL-based vital events database
- Process incoming registration data from the conservatories and mobile-based registrations from administrative registration posts, and
- Manage access to different datasets based on access credentials provided to registration officials.

Back-end applications are also programmed to provide a range of data reports for authorized officials as well as a range of real-time statistical reports, either for system managers or the general public (who can access the information through the e-CRVS website). In 2019, technical capacity was transferred from NDRN to the National Institute for Electronic Government, ensuring Government ownership while saving costs. The institute, mandated to oversee e-governance and interoperability standards, has become a key

partner in providing technical assistance to the NDRN in managing the e-CRVS system, as well as guiding the process of interoperability with other government data systems.

Full system rollout was largely completed in 2018. Thanks in part to UNICEF interventions over a three-year period:

- Legislative adjustment in the Civil Registration Code was adopted by parliament
- e-CRVS was rolled out and made functional in 75 districts and 183 administrative posts
- A total of 292 staff were trained in its use, including 134 from MoJCAR, 109 from the National Institute of Statistics, 43 from the Ministry of Interior and six from state administration
- In 2018, the new system registered 54,539 people, including 33,878 children under the age of 1.

In 2019, with financial and technical support from UNICEF, the e-CRVS system was expanded to an additional 46 conservatories and 38 registration posts, and an additional 314 staff were trained in e-CRVS by NDRN. Also in that year, 554,892 people were registered (133,954 children under 1 year). With financial support from UNICEF Mozambique, two conservatories in Niassa and Inhambane province were rehabilitated to ensure secure conditions and proper working environments for e-CRVS users. A call centre was set up in Nampula to attend civil registration queries.

The value of the newly digitized e-CRVS system was demonstrated in 2019 in the aftermath of Cyclone Idai. With support from the Japanese Government, UNICEF Mozambique supported birth registration campaigns and reproduction of damaged birth registration materials. A total of 72,000 people (including 36,399 children) benefitted and had legal documents re-issued, allowing them to access basic social services. In eight conservatories (Chibabava, Caia, Nhamatanda, Sussudenga, Gondola, Quissanga, Meluco and Macomia), solar panels were installed to continue electronic registration during power outages following the cyclones.



In 2019, UNICEF also supported e-CRVS system expansion to an additional 46 conservatories and 38 registration posts.

3 Engage communities to demand birth registration for every child

From the beginning, the UNICEF strategy for strengthening the CRVS system in Mozambique recognized that increasing capacities on the supply side should be coupled with an equal effort to address the lack of demand for registration services from general population. Support to the semi-annual National Health Weeks, as described in 2.4.4 above, was part of this strategy.

UNICEF also supported the work of community child protection committees, which identified 71,133 vulnerable children, conducted needs assessments, provided services directly or referred children and family members to existing statutory and non-statutory services. UNICEF also signed a three-year partnership agreement with Save the Children to support demand creation, through which 9,728 people were reached with social mobilization activities. Save the Children also trained community leaders and community committees for the protection of children (CCPCs) and conducted formative research to better understand why people were not registering births and deaths. Based on the results, Save the Children hired a team of consultants to develop a communications strategy. Save the Children also distributed 5,272 flyers to CCPCs, teachers, MoJCAR and the Ministry of Health.

At the provincial level, the civil society network was also involved in round tables and other meetings with local government and private sector to discuss issues affecting children in their provinces, such as child marriage, birth registration and child abuse.

UNICEF also organized the dissemination of key messages through theatre, lectures, workshops, home visits and songs about birth and death registration, reaching a total of 17,696 people

in the four target provinces of Maputo, Gaza, Zambézia and Nampula. This included 8,494 adults (3,993 men and 4,501 women) and 9,202 children (4,325 boys and 4,877 girls). Furthermore, UNICEF produced more than 3,000 T-shirts with the slogan “Let’s register the children” in response to a request from the Government. The T-shirts were distributed to trained CCPC members, Government staff, community and religious leaders, and community-based organizations staff in Maputo, Gaza, Zambezia and Nampula.

UNICEF also explored public-private partnerships as a viable option for increasing demand for registration services. In 2014, UNICEF launched a new public-private partnership to support birth registration of 200,000 children (0-14 years) in Nampula province and provide national identification documents to 350,000 people. The partnership involves Global Affairs Canada, a private forestry company (Green Resources), the MoJCAR and the Ministry of Interior. In 2015, this project led to the registration of about 35,000 children and the provision of 12,000 adult identity documents (ID). The public-private partnership in Nampula province was identified as a positive example of a partnership for service delivery and has resulted in further expansion of the intervention for an additional two years. A similar partnership is being carried out in Cabo Delgado province for a period of four months.

4 Building coalitions and strengthening collaborations

UNICEF provides technical assistance to MoJCAR, the National Institute of Statistics and the Ministries of Health and Interior to support the rollout of the digitized civil registration system. MoJCAR holds regular meetings of the GITEV to ensure quality of the rollout and inter-ministerial coordination, with a direct reporting line to the steering committee. The steering committee supervises the development of the costed operational plan and proposal to the World Bank/Global Financing Facility to assure future funding and sustainability of the programme.



UNICEF leads the United Nations task team on CRVS, which includes WHO, the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, the United Nations Population Fund and the United Nations Development Programme to align behind the Government coordination structure and deliver as one. With the sponsorship of the Swedish Government, UNICEF works closely with MoJCAR and the Ministry of the Interior in support of partnerships in Nampula and Palma with private sector companies. Together with Save the Children, UNICEF also supports social mobilization around the rollout of the programme, as outlined above.

UNICEF Mozambique played a key role in facilitating the first country visit of the World Bank ID4D programme by leveraging and promoting an identity ecosystem linked to the civil

registration system to ensure a holistic approach to legal identity from birth to death. Led by the Government, UNICEF Mozambique and the World Bank held joint meetings both with governments as well as development partners and conducted a U-Report survey on access to identity documents.

In 2019, UNICEF Mozambique engaged in a new, two-year partnership with Green Resources and the Norwegian embassy to increase birth registration and access to legal identity in Niassa Province, aiming to reach 125,605 children aged 0-14. This partnership also aims to fortify the linkage between civil registration and the health sector by opening five registration posts in health facilities and the use of health community workers as birth notifiers.





4

KEY OBSERVATIONS

4.1 Relevance

The UNICEF Mozambique programme on CRVS contributes directly to the outcomes of Mozambique's United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework and is specifically designed to support the objectives of the Government's five-year plan objectives. It is also linked to several Sustainable Development Goals, such as 16 & 17 (Peace and Justice Strong Institutions, Partnerships for the Goals) and contributes to Article 7 of the Convention of the Rights of the Child. UNICEF assistance was targeted toward expanding registration services into remote areas of the country and to reach the most disadvantaged populations.

As a key development partner supporting CRVS reforms, UNICEF Mozambique was instrumental in the implementation of the National Strategic Plan for CRVS. In the legislative area, UNICEF Mozambique's advocacy and support helped to create an enabling legal framework for the implementation of the reforms. It provided authorities in Mozambique with the required technical expertise, know-how and material support for the digitization of the CRVS system from the central to the most local administrative level, where the decentralized registration system was implemented. The programme also helped to increase demand for registration through dedicated outreach campaigns, including in partnership with others (e.g. Save the Children and the private sector).

4.2 Effectiveness

UNICEF Mozambique was an important driver of the reform process, providing support in key areas where the Government was lacking resources, technical expertise and know-how. UNICEF Mozambique worked closely with NDRN on redesigning and digitizing of birth and death registration business processes. This assistance included actual design and implementation of the ICT architecture and the software platform for the electronic collection, processing and keeping of registration records. The resulting product is a custom-built platform that reflects the needs of the Mozambique registration system. From 2014 to 2020, UNICEF Mozambique provided technical and financial support that aligned Mozambique's CRVS system with other advanced contemporary CRVS systems. In many aspects it represents one of the most successful interventions in overhauling civil registration systems on the African continent. The evidence of successful intervention is also demonstrated in increased birth and death registration coverage.

In addition, digitized processing of registration data creates a range of other opportunities. The NDRN database is recognized as one of the pillars of future e-government platforms and critical for the functioning of future e-government services that require direct interaction with citizens. Such services will obtain the personal information of 'customers' not by verifying claimed identity data against paper certificates but by looking up identity data directly in the civil register database. With such long-term perspectives in mind, it is no longer critical that the paper certificates are widely issued but that all events are captured and reflected in the database.



At the same time, UNICEF Mozambique missed opportunities to strengthen the value of the CRVS system as part of overall public administration system. The CRVS system can still be better integrated with the national ID system, social services distribution and health, as well as many other public governance systems.

For the time being, the central civil register stores in digital format only information on events registered from 2016, representing a fraction of all vital events records. Digitization of historic vital events records would position the CRVS system as the most relevant source of identity data and raise the importance of the civil registration database in the context of electronic public governance services in the future. At this stage, only modest efforts have been made in that regard, with Italian Cooperation assisting NDRN with the digitization of historic archives. Failure to aggregate all registration records in the NDRN database carries the risk that other public administration authorities begin seeking other digital sources of identity data. Regional trends suggest that national ID databases are increasingly seen as viable alternatives to civil register databases in spite of the fact that they generally store data of the adult population only. By practically positioning the civil register as a pillar of e-governance services, its critical importance for the functioning of the entire e-governance platform will be as consequence matched with coordinated effort by all public administration stakeholders to ensure universal coverage. Should this not be the case, the civil register runs the risk of being 'sidelined' in terms of future Government priorities.

Evidence suggests that the lack of tighter integration of CRVS with other identity management actors is the result of a lack of political agreement within the coordination mechanism. The lack of agreement to include health facilities among registration agents within the decentralized system remains the key obstacle to increasing registration rates, and UNICEF Mozambique continues to advocate strongly in this regard.

4.3 Coherence

The UNICEF Mozambique CRVS programme was aligned with broader Government goals for digitization of the public government system. Mozambique is among the first African countries to identify and operationalize information and communication technologies as a cross-cutting issue and a key development tool for CRVS. The inter-ministerial discussion within the GITEV worked from the beginning develop a digital national civil register. The register was considered within the context of broader plans for the development of e-government systems through which all GITEV stakeholders access personal data stored. Statistic authorities foresee the civil register as the main source of data for vital statistics. This way, UNICEF Mozambique helped raise the role of the CRVS system in effective governance, which in turn should result in sustained support for the system.

UNICEF Mozambique from the very beginning worked closely with UNECA in the context of the APAI-CRVS Regional Core Group, which led to Mozambique to become the first African country to conduct a comprehensive CRVS assessment and develop an investment plan and later a costed CRVS operational plan. UNICEF Mozambique also ensured that the cooperation framework with UNECA/APAI-CRVS worked in both directions and actively contributed to developing a regional guide on digitization of vital events registration processes. This globally recognized reference tool is largely built on the experience of the digitization of the civil registration system in Mozambique.

At the provincial level, the civil society network was also involved in round tables and other meetings with local government and private sector to discuss issues affecting children in their provinces, such as child marriage, birth registration and child abuse, elevating child rights issues in the provincial agenda. To support the national and decentralized level of commitments and understanding of the system, three regional consultation meetings were held in the north, centre and south of Mozambique,



which generated buy-in for the new system from core civil registry staff on the ground.

Legislative support and UNICEF advocacy was instrumental in creating an enabling environment for digitized civil registration records-processing and the introduction of NUICs through relevant legislation in parliament. With UNICEF Mozambique support, the Government drafted a new strategic plan for CRVS to secure investment for a sustainable system. Partnership agreements with the MoJCAR and the Ministry of Health were discussed for opening birth registration facilities at health posts and for the training of health workers on notification of births.

UNICEF Mozambique adequately leveraged its position as key United Nations agency providing support in strengthening of the national CRVS system, with the view to involving other stakeholders in the reform processes. The United Nations task team on CRVS, led by UNICEF, ensured that assistance was provided within the framework of an inter-agency programme.

UNICEF was instrumental in leveraging the partnerships required to make this system operational, securing the participation of major mobile network operators in Mozambique. UNICEF Mozambique recognized that mobile operators could benefit from being associated with the registration process and from being recognized as socially responsible service providers. Mobile operators provide network bandwidth free of charge and operate a platform that receives mobile messages and converts the information into a format that is compatible with the central NDRN database. In addition, mobile operators provide the additional service of notifying informants with an SMS that registration in the CRVS system has been completed and that the registration certificate is ready for collection.

4.4 Innovation

UNICEF applied innovative approaches in addressing some of the challenges that emerged in the process of designing the digitized business registration processes.

Lack of internet connectivity in some areas of the country, and in particular in remote administrative posts, was resolved by introducing a mobile notification system utilizing local mobile networks. Upon receipt of the mobile message, the NDRN system promptly sends back to the registration agent a NUIC for the newly registered child. This serves as guarantee that a child's identity has been entered in the birth register and officially recognized by the state. From that point onward, informants/parents can use this NUIC to look up the identity of the child in a range of government databases, a type of service that is likely to increase dramatically in use as the Government continues to develop interoperable ICT platforms.



5

CONCLUSIONS AND CONSIDERATIONS

The reforms of the civil registration and vital statistics (CRVS) system undertaken in Mozambique from 2014–2020 provide a useful illustration of the sorts of improvements to CRVS systems that can be achieved within a relatively short timeframe and in a sustainable manner. It also provides an opportunity to assess the contribution of UNICEF in driving such processes forward, including the extent to which such contributions supported national ownership and sustainability. By including Mozambique in the sample of case study countries, the evaluation is able to examine the extent to which UNICEF has been effective in supporting and strengthening an established and highly functional CRVS system at national level, thus helping increase vital events registration rates.

5.1 Limitations of this case study

This case study is the result of a desk review of UNICEF Mozambique CRVS programme documents, supplemented by a review of other available documents from government and non-government stakeholders in Mozambique. It was developed during the period when the world was engulfed in the COVID-19 pandemic, which severely curtailed global travel and limited in-person social contacts. As a result, this study lacked on-site consultations with key interlocutors in Mozambique, limiting the inclusion of additional perspectives. Taking into account the period covered by this study, obtaining direct feedback from many UNICEF and non-UNICEF interlocutors was no longer possible due to staff rotation within UNICEF as well as within Brazilian government structures. The ability to

consult officials involved with CRVS reforms at the beginning of the observed period would have been useful to better understand specific strategic decisions made early in the reform process and which have decisively affected CRVS reforms over past eight years.

A second limitation relates to the lack of baseline data showing the change in registration rates over specific periods of time. Data limitations also make it impossible to analyse these dynamics in relation to equity indicators such as types of settlement, age groups, wealth or sex. As a result, analysis in this case study is based on data gathered through household surveys, where possible from the same type of surveys. Where such sources were not available, surveys using different data-gathering methodologies were used. Thus, data points across a given period of time are not fully comparable. Nevertheless, they can be interpreted as trend indicators.

5.2 Lessons learned and good practices

A comprehensive assessment in line with the APAI-CRVS methodology provided important impetus for high-level commitment to embarking on reforms to the CRVS system in Mozambique. Advocating for and supporting the conduct of the assessment represents a strategic decision by UNICEF that helped spearhead the entire reform process and was crucial for generating sustained political commitment from key national stakeholders. It was instrumental in defining key interventions and ultimately led to a Government commitment and created confidence among the donor community to finance the reforms.



The comprehensive assessment also added value in providing a consultative process through which key strategic reform interventions were developed. These consultations involved national stakeholders as well as external expertise; this empowered UNICEF to develop well-informed programme responses backed by demonstrated political commitment to overhauling the CRVS system.

Recognizing the importance of maintaining sustained political commitment to the reform process, UNICEF nurtured and supported consultations within the national coordination mechanism, ensuring that decisions were addressed in a timely manner. This strategic intervention is also replicated in the context of coordination among United Nations agencies operating in Mozambique, where UNICEF maintained a leadership role in coordinating support to CRVS reforms.

The experience of Mozambique shows how UNICEF can support the rollout of a decentralized CRVS system. Through this approach, UNICEF helped to expand the number of registration points and integrate them within one seamless CRVS system.

The use of digital technologies has the potential to enable easier aggregation of registered data as well as their processing, storage and sharing. UNICEF supported the digitization of vital event registration, thereby creating a system where registration records can be retrieved instantly, including remotely. District registration offices also benefitted from access to digital records kept in the central register. Digitized collection, processing and storage of registration data provides a range of important benefits. For instance, any registration record can be retrieved instantly by any registration point connected to the central database, and registration certificates can be printed. Centralized digital processing of registration records also greatly improves the integrity of the registration process, allowing authorities to identify multiple registrations of a single event. The introduction of NUIC further reduces the likelihood of a single event being registered more than once.

Another significant benefit of digitized systems comes from the ability to share registration data with the ICT platforms of other public administration bodies. As each person's legal identity information changes from birth until death, digitized CRVS systems enable all other public administration stakeholders to operate with the most up-to-date legal identity information of their customers and/or beneficiaries. Permanent and continuous registration of vital life events as they occur positions the CRVS systems as the primary source of up-to-date information on legal identity. This also extends to the extraction of vital statistics information. The health sector would benefit from the stable linkage to identity information from the civil register, including the ability to ensure that the records of patients are up-to-date, especially in the case of minors. The health system also benefits from being informed of new births in the communities within their jurisdiction. This further enables better planning of service delivery, immunization and other health services for children. Interoperability and interconnection between government ICT platforms is the key precondition for these concepts to become a reality.

The implementation of the mobile network-based electronic notification system in Mozambique represents a successful implementation of this type of notification, which UNICEF has supported in several countries in Africa and Asia. In Mozambique, the system helped promptly capture information on births as they occurred in remote areas. It helps authorities to monitor the registration process across the entire country and follow up when registration data received deviate significantly from the established trends.

5.3 Issues for future investigation

While a digitized civil registration system brings numerous benefits, keeping the system self-sustainable over time can be challenging. In Mozambique, the establishment of the system is largely managed and financed by UNICEF, in close coordination with national registration authorities.



UNICEF support in strengthening the capacity of national registration authorities to maintain and upgrade the system in future is still being sought by national authorities. Some risks are also associated with the decentralized nature of the registration process. For instance, the capacity of registrars at sub-national level can become an issue. Limited availability of resources, maintaining training programmes for registration agents, and the lack of internet connectivity create additional challenges. Ensuring the integrity of the registration process also becomes more difficult as the number of registration points increases.

The current system, which relies largely on registration points in the communities, only partially succeeded in bringing registration services to the points where birth events actually occur. UNICEF Mozambique should continue advocating for the inclusion of data from health facilities in the decentralized registration system. Reaching political agreement within GITEV to expand registration points in all health facilities would further increase the birth registration rate. In 2019, 84.8 per cent of births in Mozambique occurred in a health facility.¹¹ This underlines the potential for increasing registration rates should registration points be opened in maternity wards.

The lack of political agreement within the coordination mechanism also resulted in a missed opportunity to link the civil register database with the identification database operated by the Ministry of Interior (Mol). Institutionalized cooperation between NDRN and the Mol would allow the NDRN to take advantage of identification records to build a comprehensive population register that could be used as source of legal identity data for the population and other public administration stakeholders. UNICEF Mozambique will need to strengthen advocacy and invest resources in conjunction with partners to support the development of a holistic CRVS and identity management system that strengthens the value of CRVS for overall governance and demonstrates its value to the general population, with a view to increasing demand for vital event registration.

¹¹ Mozambique National Institute of Statistics, 'Statistical Yearbook, 2019', Government of Mozambique, Maputo, 2020



Annex 1 Data for Evidence Story

Birth registration among children 0–4 years old

	2011		2015	
	% of children with births registered	No. of children	% of children with births registered	No. of children
Age				
Less than 2 years	36.2	4562	49.7	2301
2–4 years	56.5	6156	58.6	3430
Sex				
Male	47.8	5356	53.9	2871
Female	47.9	5362	56.1	2859
Residence				
Urban	50.6	2986	63.7	1495
Rural	46.8	7732	51.9	4236
Province				
Niassa	35.1	676	50.4	380
Cabo Delgado	43.6	899	50.6	544
Nampula	59.0	1675	73.4	1278
Zambezia	26.8	2222	51.0	786
Tete	76.3	1339	45.3	466
Manica	67.1	760	42.6	465
Sofala	40.2	1021	48.9	577
Inhambape	43.2	579	52.1	347
Gaza	31.2	582	51.9	473
Maputo Province	57.3	597	54.9	228
Maputo City	54.8	368	55.2	186
Wealth Quintiles				
Lowest	42.3	2482	50.1	1330
Second	43.1	2292	51.5	1279
Third	47.8	2162	53.9	1207
Fourth	50.2	2149	59.2	1074
Highest	60.2	1633	63.9	841
Total	47.9	10,718	55.0	5,731

NOTE: Data extracted from: Mozambique DHS 2011, Table 2.9 page 31, Mozambique IMASIDA 2015, Table 2.8, page 28.



Annex 2 List of documents reviewed

GITEV Inter-Institutional Working Group on Vital Statistics	The Vital Statistics Journey: A case study of Mozambique, 2014
Government of Mozambique	Draft CRVS Indicative Investment Plan for Mozambique, 2014 https://getinthepicture.org/sites/default/files/resources/moz_crvs_investment_plan_2014.pdf
IDRC Centre of Excellence for CRVS Systems	Snapshot of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems of Mozambique, 2019
National Statistics Institute of Mozambique	Final Report of The Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey, 2008
UNECA	Mozambique Rapid Assessment Report
UNICEF Eastern and Southern Africa	Review of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Innovations in Eastern and Southern Africa Region: Digitization, processes, and strategies (synthesis report)
UNICEF Mozambique	Building Awareness on Electronic Civil Registration Vital Statistics in Mozambique (final report)
UNICEF Mozambique	Outcome 7, Social Inclusion: Strategy note
UNICEF Mozambique	Mozambique Child Protection Programme 2017–2020
UNICEF Mozambique	UNICEF Annual Report, 2014
UNICEF Mozambique	UNICEF Annual Report, 2015
UNICEF Mozambique	UNICEF Annual Report, 2016
UNICEF Mozambique	UNICEF Annual Report, 2017
UNICEF Mozambique	Country Office Annual Report, 2018
UNICEF Mozambique	UNICEF Annual Report, 2019
UNICEF Mozambique/ WHO	Strengthening Civil Registration and Vital Statistics in Mozambique: Joint programme progress report to the Government of Canada



For further information, please contact:

Evaluation Office United Nations Children's Fund
Three United Nations Plaza
New York, New York 10017
evalhelp@unicef.org

© United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)